CELPIP EXPRESS

Listening Test

STUDY MATERIALS - 13

PART 1

Listening to Problem Solving

Question 1 of 8: Choose the best answer to each question.

- ◯ Tiger has been going outside.
- ◯ Tiger's not playful anymore.
- ◯ Tiger has a lot of insect bites.
- ◯ Tiger's claws are too sharp.

Question 2 of 8: Choose the best answer to each question.

- ◯ Avoid picking Tiger up.
- ◯ Clean Tiger's fur.
- ◯ Give Tiger medication.
- ◯ Keep Tiger indoors.

Question 3 of 8: Choose the best answer to each question.

- ◯ The vet prescribed the wrong drug.
- ◯ The drug made the problem worse.
- ◯ The cat got only two skin treatments.
- ◯ The man lost the cat's medication.

Question 4 of 8: Choose the best answer to each question.

- ◯ He tends to be disorganized.
- ◯ He has other pets at home.
- ◯ He keeps his house clean.
- ◯ He stays out late at night.

Question 5 of 8: Choose the best answer to each question.

- ◯ He didn't follow the instructions.
- ◯ He forgot to pay for his last visit.
- ◯ Tiger scratched the vet.
- ◯ Tiger got outside at night.

Question 6 of 8: Choose the best answer to each question.

- ◯ Her skin problem needs follow-up.
- ◯ She needs her claws trimmed.
- ◯ Her eating habits have changed.
- ◯ She seems to be getting heavier.

Question 7 of 8: Choose the best answer to each question

- ◯ confused
- ◯ surprise
- ◯ relief
- ◯ worry

Question 8 of 8: Choose the best answer to each question

- ◯ Find people who want to adopt cats.
- ◯ Keep giving Tiger the flea medication.
- ◯ Locate a vet who can do the surgery.
- ◯ Stop letting Tiger eat too much food.

PART 2

Listening to a Daily Life Conversation

Question 1 of 5: Choose the best answer.

- ◯ classmates
- ◯ husband and wife
- ◯ brother and sister
- ◯ friends

Question 2 of 5: Choose the best answer.

- ◯ afraid
- ◯ annoyed
- ◯ happy
- ◯ interested

Question 3 of 5: Choose the best answer.

- ◯ visit friends
- ◯ visit the thrift store
- ◯ see a movie
- ◯ eat at a restaurant

Question 4 of 5: Choose the best answer.

- ◯ buying a new shirt
- ◯ giving away their belongings
- ◯ visiting the woman's sister in London
- ◯ what to wear for a party

Question 5 of 5: Choose the best answer.

- ◯ He looks good in it.
- ◯ It was on sale.
- ◯ It's fashionable.
- ◯ It's her favourite colour.

PART 3

Listening for Information

Question 1 of 6: Choose the best answer.

- ◯ in an apartment
- ◯ in an office
- ◯ in a lobby
- ◯ in a coffee shop

Question 2 of 6: Choose the best answer

- ◯ a tenant of an apartment building
- ◯ a local real estate agent
- ◯ an apartment building manager
- ◯ a renovation contractor

Question 3 of 6: Choose the best answer.

- ◯ renovate it
- ◯ sell it
- ◯ lease it
- ◯ buy it

Question 4 of 6: Choose the best answer.

- ◯ One is much larger than the other.
- ◯ The space is arranged differently.
- ◯ One is more expensive than the other.
- ◯ The lease is shorter for one apartment.

Question 5 of 6: Choose the best answer.

- ◯ She's often away.
- ◯ She's a student.
- ◯ She works nearby.
- ◯ She has a dog.

Question 6 of 6: Choose the best answer.

- ◯ layout
- ◯ elevation
- ◯ move-in date
- ◯ square footage

PART 4

Listening to a News Item

1. Willis _____
- ◯ went for a walk near his home.
- ◯ watched a magic show.
- ◯ couldn't find his dog.
- ◯ got lost in an unfamiliar city.

2. He remembered that earlier he _____
- ◯ was in a crowd.
- ◯ spent all his money.
- ◯ was on a busy street.
- ◯ was biking in the park.

3. He used the tracking device to _____
- ◯ ensure that he didn't get lost.
- ◯ find out where his wallet was.
- ◯ train his dog to return home.
- ◯ find the nearest police station.

4. The police quickly _____
- ◯ found the wallet.
- ◯ recorded the details.
- ◯ contacted other stations.
- ◯ used dogs to find the wallet.

5. Willis was delighted that the _____
- ◯ precaution worked so well.
- ◯ police were so efficient.
- ◯ magician helped them.
- ◯ police located the thief.

PART 5

Listening to a Discussion

1. Why does the younger man mention his co-worker's car?
- ◯ to acknowledge her car has new wheels
- ◯ to compliment her on her new purchase
- ◯ to imply she has spent too much money
- ◯ to tease her about how shiny her car is

2. What is the woman's main complaint?
- ◯ She is bothered by toxic chemicals.
- ◯ She isn't able to get her car clean.
- ◯ She hasn't got a parking space.
- ◯ She has to pay a fine to the city.

3. Which statement is true of the younger man?
- ◯ He gave a co-worker a nice gift.
- ◯ He has an ash tree in his yard.
- ◯ He knows some facts about aphids.
- ◯ He likes eating sweet honeydew.

4. What is there a law against?
- ◯ cutting down healthy trees
- ◯ parking overnight on the street
- ◯ spraying chemicals on plants
- ◯ wasting tap water on city lawns

5. What is most likely true of the ash tree?
- ◯ People don't relax underneath it.
- ◯ It needs more water to survive.
- ◯ The city won't bother to save it.
- ◯ It may fall onto a nearby roof.

6. Why does the man wearing glasses talk about water?
- ◯ to accept the other woman's idea
- ◯ to expand on the previous point
- ◯ to suggest an alternate solution
- ◯ to warn about a possible danger

PART 5

7. What can we tell from the conversation?

- ◯ The company has a city tree removal permit.
- ◯ The man has insects in his ash tree at home.
- ◯ The company wants to help the environment.
- ◯ The man appreciates attractive automobiles.

8. What is the best subject line for the woman's email?

- ◯ cutting down a diseased ash tree
- ◯ seeking advice on car paint job
- ◯ requesting alternate parking spot
- ◯ spraying trees near my vehicle

PART 6

Listening for Viewpoints

1. The professor in favour of e-textbooks wants to _____

- ◯ relieve some of the financial pressure that students face.
- ◯ cut corners in order to streamline administrative procedures.
- ◯ request compensation for any extra work performed.
- ◯ expose students to a variety of viewpoints.

2. The professor who is writing an e-textbook _____

- ◯ is also writing senior level law course textbooks.
- ◯ is working with several other professors.
- ◯ has written print textbooks in the past.
- ◯ will receive financial compensation for her work.

3. One professor believes that if professors wrote e-textbooks, then _____

- ◯ students would appreciate the traditional textbooks more.
- ◯ there would be concern about the additional work.
- ◯ the compensation demanded by professors would be costly.
- ◯ keeping the texts up-to-date would be time consuming.

4. The professor who prefers print textbooks believes that _____

- ◯ the role of a professor is quite challenging.
- ◯ publishing companies charge too much for textbooks.
- ◯ discounts should be provided to students in need.
- ◯ a professor's job involves writing textbooks.

5. According to the lecture, publishing companies _____

- ◯ are publishing more textbooks in electronic form.
- ◯ provide discounts for bulk purchases of textbooks.
- ◯ ensure up-to-date information by publishing new editions.
- ◯ require a long period of time to publish a print text.

6. According to the history professor, students _____

- ◯ may choose either print or electronic textbooks.
- ◯ can download electronic textbook updates in class.
- ◯ should apply for bursaries to cover textbook costs.
- ◯ can choose not to purchase their textbooks.

Answer Key

PART 1	
Question 1	Tiger has a lot of insect bites.
Question 2	Give Tiger medication.
Question 3	The cat got only two skin treatments.
Question 4	He tends to be disorganized.
Question 5	He didn't follow the instructions.
Question 6	She seems to be getting heavier.
Question 7	surprise
Question 8	Find people who want to adopt cats.

PART 2	
Question 1	husband and wife
Question 2	annoyed
Question 3	visit friends
Question 4	giving away their belongings
Question 5	He looks good in it.

PART 3	
Question 1	in an office
Question 2	an apartment building manager
Question 3	lease it
Question 4	The space is arranged differently.
Question 5	She's often away.
Question 6	elevation

PART 4	
Question 1	watched a magic show.
Question 2	was in a crowd.
Question 3	find out where his wallet was.
Question 4	found the wallet.
Question 5	precaution worked so well.

PART 5	
Question 1	to compliment her on her new purchase
Question 2	She isn't able to get her car clean.
Question 3	He knows some facts about aphids.
Question 4	cutting down healthy trees
Question 5	People don't relax underneath it.
Question 6	to suggest an alternate solution
Question 7	The man appreciates attractive automobiles.
Question 8	requesting alternate parking spot

PART 6	
Question 1	relieve some of the financial pressure that students face.
Question 2	is working with several other professors.
Question 3	there would be concern about the additional work.
Question 4	the role of a professor is quite challenging.
Question 5	require a long period of time to publish a print text.
Question 6	may choose either print or electronic textbooks.

Transcripts

Listening to Problem Solving

You will hear a conversation between a woman and a man at a veterinary clinic. The woman is a veterinarian, and the man is a pet owner.

Section 1:

MAN: Hi, Dr. Anderson. This is my cat, Tiger. Tiger, meet Dr. Anderson.

WOMAN: Hello, Tiger. Aren't you a lovely cat.

MAN: I'm really worried about her. She's usually so playful, but this past week all she's been doing is scratching herself. Her claws are sharp, and she's hurting herself. Look, here.

WOMAN: I see what you mean. Is Tiger an indoor or an outdoor cat?

MAN: Mostly outdoors. I let her stay outside at night.

WOMAN: These marks look like flea bites. If Tiger's going outdoors, it's almost certain that she's picked up fleas. I'll give you some medication to kill them. Apply it to her skin—right here—once a month for three months.

MAN: Okay. Will the fleas get into my house?

WOMAN: Well . . . fleas only live on animals. After Tiger receives the medication, they can't live on her anymore, so they'll die. But you should vacuum and clean every day to get rid of any flea eggs. If need be, I can always give you a product to apply to your rugs and furniture.

Now answer questions 1-2.

1. What is the main problem with Tiger?
2. What advice did the veterinarian give the man?

Section 2:

MAN: We're back! So I used the medication, but Tiger's still been scratching a lot since her last appointment. At first, she started getting better, but now she's getting worse.

WOMAN: Hmm. [Pause] Ooh . . . yes, I see what you mean. That must hurt. Did you give her the medication once a month, for three months?

MAN: Yes . . . [Pause] Well . . . okay, maybe I missed the last dose. It just slipped my mind. And I guess I only got around to vacuuming once.

WOMAN: You really have to give her three doses of the medication over three months . . . and you need to vacuum every day. Here are another three doses. You can pay the receptionist.

MAN: Okay, thanks. I promise I'll be more on top of things this time. Sorry about that.

WOMAN: Okay. And think about keeping her inside at night.

Now answer questions 3-5.

3. Why did the man have to come back?
4. Which statement best describes Tiger's owner?
5. Why did the owner apologize to the vet?

Transcripts

Section 3:

WOMAN: How's Tiger today? Still scratching? [Pause] I see you trimmed her claws.

MAN: No more fleas! But it's weird . . . she's gaining a lot of weight, even though she's eating more or less the same amount as usual.

WOMAN: Hmm. She hasn't been spayed yet, has she?

MAN: Right, no surgery yet. She's too young to get pregnant.

WOMAN: Where'd you hear that? Actually, cats can get pregnant even at six months of age. [Pause] From the way her abdomen feels, I'd say Tiger's going to be a mother soon.

MAN: You're kidding! That's the last thing I expected.

WOMAN: If she's going to keep going outdoors, you really need to get her spayed. It's a simple operation; I can do it after she gives birth. In the meantime, you have some things to do.

Now answer questions 6-8.

6. Why did the man bring Tiger back?
7. How did the man react to the vet's new information?
8. What should the man do next?

Transcripts

Listening to a Daily Life Conversation

You will hear a conversation about donating items to a thrift store.

MAN: Julie, is that you? We're going to be late to Susan and Anthony's housewarming party!

WOMAN: Yes, it's me, who else would it be? I was just getting groceries on the way home. You sound upset. Is something wrong?

MAN: I can't find my favorite grey shirt, the one with the stripes. Did you put it somewhere? It's not in the laundry or the closet.

WOMAN: Uh oh… I think I donated that one to the thrift store last week. You said you didn't wear it anymore!

MAN: No, that was the solid grey one with the stained collar that I don't wear anymore; the one with the stripes, I just bought recently, and it was on sale, too!

WOMAN: I'm sorry! We should make an agreement to always check with each other before we give things away or sell them. Remember last fall when you sold my tennis rackets at the garage sale and didn't tell me?

MAN: Well, you never play tennis. You haven't played tennis since Mary was born. That striped shirt, I've been wearing all the time!

WOMAN: That's not true. I played tennis at least three times last summer, thank you very much! I played with your sister when she came to visit from London. Anyways, let's not fight.

MAN: You're right, fighting gets us nowhere. Okay, it's a deal. We'll make an effort to ask each other from now on. I guess I'll just wear a different shirt today… I'll wear my old blue one.

WOMAN: That blue one looks great on you, anyways. You look so handsome.

MAN: Well, you have to say that, since you gave the other one away!

WOMAN: No, it really does bring out the color of your eyes! Anyways, I need to have a shower and get ready. Were we supposed to be there at 7:00? That doesn't leave me much time. Do you mind unpacking the groceries while I shower?

MAN: Yes, of course. Here, pass me the bags. You go get ready.

Now answer questions 1-5.

1. What is the relationship of the speakers?
2. How is the man feeling at the start of the conversation?
3. What are they going to do that evening?
4. What were the speakers talking about?
5. Why does the woman like the man's shirt?

Transcripts

Listening for Information

You will hear a conversation about renting an apartment.

WOMAN: Oh, hello. I saw a sign on the front door about apartments available in this building.

MAN: Uh huh.

WOMAN: It said to speak to the building manager in the administration office. The front door was open, so I thought I'd just come in and ask.

MAN: Well, you're talking to the right person. Which one are you interested in?

WOMAN: I'm not sure which would be better. The sign said Apartments 1 and 2 are both 850 square feet, but one's a one bedroom and the other's a two bedroom, so I'm a bit confused.

MAN: Apartment 2 has two separate bedrooms, each with its own door—a sort of closed floor plan if you will. Apartment 1 has what we call an open floor plan. The living room and one big bedroom are adjoined like they're one big room.

WOMAN: That type of layout sounds like a bachelor apartment to me.

MAN: Yeah, except that the bedroom area is really big, and there's sort of an archway between the living room area and the bedroom area. It's easy to separate them with a curtain or room divider.

WOMAN: I see. Well, the apartment is just for me, and I like open spaces I can use in a flexible way. However, having a second bedroom might also be useful. And the move-in date would be July 1st with a one-year lease?

MAN: Yup. Everything's newly renovated. New carpets, new paint, and all the appliances—fridge, stove, washer/dryer—are brand new. But it's a walk-up—there's no elevator. Apartment 1 is on the ground floor and Apartment 2 is on the top floor.

WOMAN: I think I'd prefer to be on the ground floor, as long as there aren't any tap dance rehearsals going on right above me. Who's the upstairs tenant?

MAN: The lady in the apartment above you is retired—really quiet and is hardly ever home. I can show you Apartment 1 around 3:00 p.m. if you'd like. Can you wait an hour?

WOMAN: Sure. I'll go for coffee and come back. See you at 3:00.

Now answer questions 1-6.

1. Where does the conversation occur?
2. Who is the woman talking to?
3. What is the man's plan for the apartment?
4. What is the difference between the two apartments?
5. What does the man say about the upstairs tenant?
6. On what basis does the woman make her choice?

Transcripts

Listening to a News Item

You will hear a news item about a stolen wallet.

A tourist in downtown Vancouver got the last laugh yesterday when pickpockets stole his wallet. Gregory Willis was about to rent bikes to tour Stanley Park with his wife when he noticed his wallet was missing. He recalled he'd been in a jostling crowd earlier that day watching a street magician performance when someone had bumped into him, but he'd taken little notice of the incident. Undaunted, Mr. Willis headed to the nearest police station and said he knew exactly where his wallet was. He'd attached a GPS chip, a small tracking device that uses the global positioning system to pinpoint location, on the inside of the wallet. Willis explained he had initially bought the chip to track their dog on their 20-acre ranch in Washington state, but had decided to take it on vacation as a precautionary measure against loss or theft. The GPS chip certainly did come in handy as the Willises, in the company of two policemen, were able to locate the wallet 30 blocks away where a group of teenagers were loitering at a park. The young thief was more than surprised when the officers showed up to arrest him.

Transcripts

Listening to a Discussion

You will watch a discussion between three co-workers in a business office. They are talking about something unusual that is happening outside.

MAN 1: So Jeanette, looks like you bought yourself a nice present. It's a pretty shiny new set of wheels in your parking spot. Is that a custom paint job?

WOMAN: Yeah! I love my new car, but I hate what's happening to it in the parking lot! You know that tree that hangs over my parking space? It's dropping this weird sticky stuff all over the hood of my car.

MAN 1: That's an ash tree. I could tell by the shape of the leaves. There's these little bugs called aphids. They suck the nectar from the leaves, and produce this sticky stuff. It's called honeydew.

WOMAN: Ugh, those things are so gross. It dries and hardens in the sun, and it's almost impossible to get off my car. It's wrecking the paint job! I'm going to ask the maintenance crew if they can just get rid of that tree.

MAN 1: Yeah, they would need a permit first though, or else the City can fine up to ten thousand dollars. It's actually illegal to remove a tree unless it poses a hazard. It could fall on a house of a power line. The City says, usually just treat it with insecticides.

MAN 2: If I were you, I wouldn't want to park where they're spraying chemicals. If it's toxic for the aphids, it's probably toxic for you too, not to mention ladybugs, birds, fish. . . .

WOMAN: Argh, maybe we could just find a way to kill the tree. Then at least they can chop it down.

MAN 2: Whoa, that's extreme. All they need to do is wash the aphids off the leaves. You know, they just need a hose that shoots a powerful stream of water. The aphids will fall off onto the ground and die. There's no food for them on the lawn.

MAN 1: Yeah, but that tree looks a little tall for a garden hose. It's got to be at least 50 feet. And I don't think the maintenance department usually deals with that kind of stuff. They'd probably want to call in a tree care company. They can decide what to do.

WOMAN: Well, I've thought about parking on the street. But I'd have to come in at like 6:00 a.m.

MAN 2: Look, just send an email to Charlie in the maintenance department. He's very accommodating. Maybe he can arrange for an eco-friendly contractor to deal with the aphids. In the meantime, I'm sure he can find you a different parking space.

Transcripts

Listening for Viewpoints

You will hear a report about the use of electronic textbooks within post-secondary institutions.

Welcome, and thank you for attending this week's lunchtime lecture. I am Professor Menendez, and our discussion today will be exploring the use of electronic textbooks within post-secondary institutions. To start, I will present the views of three professors at Riverbridge University.

Law professor Maria Bloomfield is one of several professors who has decided to completely eliminate print textbooks from her courses, arguing that their exorbitant cost adds an unnecessary financial burden on students who are already under heavy financial strain. While Bloomfield recognizes that certain costs, such as those associated with copyright, are unavoidable, she asserts that there are ways to cut corners. She proposes that professors create their own electronic textbooks; a move which, by avoiding the intermediary of a publishing company, could significantly reduce costs. Currently she is collaborating with several colleagues in order to create an e-textbook for an introductory course in law; something which she contends will save students thousands of dollars.

However, Ellen Bowler, a sociology professor at Riverbridge, has stated that she has no intention of tossing her print textbooks anytime soon. She argues that, although Bloomfield's motives are honourable, requesting professors to produce their own textbooks is unrealistic. Between teaching, research, and administrative obligations, the workload of any university professor is already extremely demanding. To request that professors develop a course textbook, in addition to their regular duties, is simply not feasible. The development of a textbook, albeit digital, involves extensive research, writing and reviewing - tasks which are time consuming and should result in compensation. However, Bowler does not expect that professors would see any increase in salary if they developed their own textbooks.

While Bloomfield acknowledges that her proposal would lead to extra work, she asserts that the effort is worth it. In this digital age, the manner in which knowledge is communicated is rapidly changing, and universities, she argues, must keep up. Publishing a print textbook takes a significant amount of time from start to finish, often resulting in the inclusion of out-of-date information. However, with the speed in which information can be updated in an electronic text, professors are better able to provide students with current and accurate information.

Although history professor Marty Brown sees the potential of e-textbooks, he disagrees with professors teaching from texts that they have written themselves, arguing that, by doing such, there is a risk of students not being exposed to the multitude of perspectives in their field. Furthermore, he insists that many students actually prefer printed textbooks to electronic ones. Accordingly, he suggests that professors assign course readings that are available in both print and electronic form, leaving the choice to the students.